Illia Vostrikov

Head of Design

Design Leadership · B2B, B2C and SaaS · Web and Mobile · Design Systems and DesignOps · AI-native design workflows

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PROFILE

Head of Design with 11+ years in product design and 7 years of leading design teams. At Valor Software I lead the design practice and have managed teams of up to 6 designers, building B2B, B2C and SaaS products for web and mobile, from discovery and research to launch. I combine hands-on product design with team building, DesignOps and design-system governance, and I base design decisions on research, testing and product metrics. Clients include the UN World Food Programme, SAP, ASI Central, Studytube, Uride, Mabrook and Breethe.

11+ years
in product design, 7 of them leading design teams

6 designers
in the largest team I've led, on up to 4 products at a time

12 hires
designers hired and onboarded onto client projects

72 interviews
with users and stakeholders run in discovery

EXPERIENCE

Valor Software — Product development partner for enterprises and startups

- **Head of Design** — 2021 - Present
  - Lead the design team, at its largest **6 designers working on up to 4 products at the same time**; own design quality, delivery and team performance.
  - Hired and onboarded **12 designers** for client projects; mentor the team and built **career paths and growth plans** for mid and senior designers.
  - Set up **DesignOps**: design critique, design QA, documentation standards and a structured handoff to engineering.
  - Own **design systems strategy and governance** across client products, from audit to adoption by multiple teams.
  - Drive discovery and research: **72 user and stakeholder interviews**, hypotheses, usability testing and product analytics.
  - Introduced **AI-native workflows** into the design process (research synthesis, rapid prototyping, documentation) for small teams and enterprise clients; author of three articles on AI in design processes.
  - Represent design in presale and strategic discussions with client product owners and leadership; scope and estimate new projects and align design, product and engineering around user and business goals.
- **Lead Product Designer** — 2019 - 2021
  - Led design on client projects from discovery to release; guided less experienced designers, ran onboarding and day-to-day design reviews.
  - Designed complex B2B platforms, data products and design systems for international clients.
- **UI/UX Designer** — 2018 - 2019
  - Designed web platforms, portals and mobile interfaces; built component libraries and documentation for handoff.

Freelance Product Designer — Upwork · Worldwide — 2015 - 2018

- Designed digital products, websites, mobile apps and brand identities for international startups and businesses.
- Managed clients end to end with a **Top Rated** profile and **100% Job Success Score**.

RECOMMENDATIONS

More on LinkedIn ↗

> *"He built a clear, well-organized design process and kept design and engineering closely aligned."*
>
> **Dmitry Zhemchugov** · COO, Mabrook (my manager)

> *"A strong design leader who combines strategic thinking, clear communication, and hands-on product design expertise."*
>
> **Viktor Zhytomyrskyi** · Senior Product Designer (my team)

> *"Exactly the kind of Head of Design who brings value far beyond design itself."*
>
> **Illia Shevchuk** · Flutter Team Lead (engineering)

SELECTED PROJECTS

Mabrook ↗
Super app, Dubai · iOS and Android

Head of Design (via Valor Software) for a super app with video, live, music, games, shopping and hotels. Led 3 product designers, set up design processes, rebuilt navigation and the design system for 16+ verticals as the product team grew from 15 to 32. **Monthly active users 4x, D7 retention 9% to 14%, release cycle 10 to 4 days.**

ASI Central · ESP+ ↗
B2B promo platform · Web and mobile

Senior Product Designer on the platform behind a $27.7B industry: Cosmos design system for two brands, POD Studio from distributor interviews, AI-assisted code prototypes with Claude. **Brief to clickable prototype 11 to 3.5 days, review rounds 3.4 to 1.3, requirement changes after sign-off -73%.**

Uride ↗
Ride-hailing, Canada · Mobile

Designed Rider and Driver apps almost from scratch with a former Uber PM; rebuilt driver registration with AI/OCR auto-fill. **Completed driver registrations 31% to 64%, document upload 35 to 9 min, ride booking 2:40 to 0:55.**

UN WFP Logistics Cluster ↗
Humanitarian logistics · Mobile and admin

Led design of an offline-first app for humanitarian field teams: full and lite versions for modern and low-end phones on 2G, a design system from scratch and an admin dashboard. **Monthly field reports +32%, time to dispatch -38%, 2x device reach.**

Studytube ↗
SaaS learning platform · B2B

Owned the design-system rebuild; with 4 designers and a UX researcher, mapped onboarding friction and redesigned the flow. **First-lesson conversion 43% to 59%.**

Breethe ↗
Wellness app · iOS, Android, Watch

Lead Product Designer for a meditation and sleep app with 18M+ downloads: personalised onboarding, Apple Watch app and an AI coach. **Onboarding drop-off -32%, trial-to-paid +16%, daytime sessions +52%.**

SAP ↗
Enterprise software · Design systems

Design-system consultant for a two-month pilot: audited 3 libraries and rebuilt the Input as the single reference, with docs, versioning and Storybook; it became the template for the library. **Input versions 5 to 1.**

More work
Data products, B2B, SaaS

Goal Tracker (SDG data visualisation for Data Act Lab), **SalesGig** (B2B lead-generation marketplace), **Precis** (marketing platform), **Homer** (AI writing SaaS), **Ashes of Creation** (game portal).

SKILLS

Leadership
Design team leadership, hiring and mentoring, career paths, performance and growth, DesignOps, stakeholder management, presale and estimation

Product and research
Product discovery, UX strategy, user interviews, usability testing, hypotheses and validation, product analytics, information architecture

Systems and craft
Design systems and governance, design tokens, interaction design, prototyping, web and mobile (iOS, Android), dashboards and data visualisation, accessibility (WCAG)

Tools
Figma, Figma Make, Claude, Cursor, ChatGPT, Webflow, Storybook, Amplitude, Google Analytics, Notion

LANGUAGES

English	Fluent
Ukrainian	Native
Russian	Native
Spanish	Intermediate

EDUCATION

Specialist degree, Automation of Technological Processes and Production
Kharkiv National University of Civil Engineering and Architecture · 2004 - 2009

CERTIFICATIONS

Anthropic · AI Fluency Framework and Foundations	2026
Anthropic · AI Capabilities and Limitations	2026
OpenAI · AI Foundations	2025
Memorisely · AI Prototyping with Figma Make	2025
Adobe · Generative AI for Creativity and Innovation	2024
Pluralsight · Product Design with Figma	2022
Microsoft · UX Design and Accessibility Fundamentals	2021
IBM · Design Thinking	2020
Google · UX Design, Coursera	2020
Google · Analytics Advanced	2019